## *Pakistan, Indian Muslims and the Idea of India as 'One Culture, One Nation'*

The Jan Sangh did not accept the Partition of India. Committed as it was to the idea of Akhand Bharat (united India), it always saw Partition as reversible. It believed India was 'one country, one nation' from 'Kashmir to Kanyakumari and from Attock to Cuttack'. Its leaders saw Partition as a 'mistake', a 'blunder, which should and could have been avoided'. As Madhok put it:[118]

If India then had a leader of the type of Abraham Lincoln, he would have invited Civil War rather than submitted to the partition of the country, which has not solved any problems but which has created many more new problems. This partition of India is as unnatural as the partition of Germany, as the partition of Korea or Vietnam. We are convinced that this will end … we consider it our patriotic and nationalist duty to keep the idea of Indian unity alive.

In post-Partition India, for the Jan Sangh, this translated into a belief that 'mere territorial and constitutional unity is not enough for nationalism; the foundation of one culture is essential for it'.[119] If the country had been divided on the basis of religion, in this world view, it needed to get back to being one culture. The Sangh 'has been repeatedly reminding the nation', its leaders thundered, 'that considering Muslim culture as separate entity became the basis of Two-nation theory and it was this Two-nation theory that resulted in the tragic partition of the Motherland. Hence it urges that "for the promotion of unity and nationalism, feeling of one culture should be imbibed maintaining the diversities in our national life and different modes of worship."'[120] Its leaders also had a visceral dislike of Nehru whom they saw as their primary ideological opponent.

In this idea of 'one culture' was embedded the remembrance of historical wrongs. 'What we call West Pakistan today was actually created in 1020 AD,' Madhok argued. 'We lost Sindh in 2712 AD. We lost Peshawar in 1008 AD. We lost Lahore in 1020 AD. If we had thought they were lost for all times, then we could not have gone